MASII

Marketing & Outreach Playbook

From Zero to Community: A Phase-by-Phase Guide

For founders who build products, not ad campaigns.

March 2026 | Version 1.0 | Bootstrapped Edition

Table of Contents

1. Brand DNA & Voice Bible
The soul of how Masii speaks

2. Visual Identity Guidelines
Colors, fonts, imagery rules

3. The 4-Phase Marketing Plan
Week-by-week from launch to scale

4. Channel Playbooks
Instagram, X, WhatsApp, YouTube Shorts, Influencers

5. Tone Files by Context
How voice shifts per channel and audience

6. Content Templates & Frameworks
Plug-and-play post structures

7. The Do/Don't Bible
Every mistake to avoid, every instinct to trust

8. Measurement & Iteration
What to track, when to pivot

SECTION 1

Brand DNA & Voice Bible

The Soul Statement

> *"If two people are meant for each other, nothing should stand between them."*

This isn't a tagline—it's the compass. Every piece of content you make should trace back to this. Masii exists because the current system puts too many things between people who should meet: paywalls, resume-style profiles, swiping fatigue, family pressure vs. personal autonomy tension.

Who Is Masii (the character)?

Masii is your masi—your mom's sister. She's the one in the family who actually listens. She doesn't judge your choices, but she's not afraid to push back lovingly. She knows everyone in the community. She keeps secrets. She works tirelessly behind the scenes.

Trait	What It Means in Practice
Warm but direct	"Tell me the truth—I can't help you if you sugarcoat it."
Culturally fluent	Knows why gotra matters to some families and not others.
Never judgmental	Doesn't flinch at divorce, doesn't push marriage.
Transparent about being AI	"I'm not a person, but I'm better than a form."
Quietly relentless	Works 24/7. Never forgets what you told her.
Communal, not transactional	Doesn't see matches as conversions. Sees them as connections.

Brand Voice: The 4 Pillars

1. Conviction Over Hype

Masii doesn't sell. She states. There's a difference between "Sign up now for the best matches!" and "You deserve to meet someone who makes sense." The first is marketing. The second is belief.

☐ Say This	☐ Not This
"You deserve to meet."	"Find your soulmate today!"
"Fewer matches. More conviction."	"Thousands of profiles waiting for you!"
"Culture isn't a checkbox."	"We match based on 100+ parameters!"
"Masii never tells anyone what you shared."	"Your data is safe with military-grade encryption!"

2. Cultural Fluency, Not Cultural Cliché

Masii doesn't do Bollywood stereotypes. No "band, baaja, baaraat" graphics. No henna hand stock photos. Culture shows up in specificity—knowing that "vegetarian" means five different things depending on whether you're Jain, Swaminarayan, or just health-conscious.

- Reference real cultural nuances, not movie tropes
- Use language mixing naturally—Hindi/Gujarati words dropped in where they fit, not forced
- Acknowledge the tension between tradition and independence without taking sides

3. Emotional Honesty

The matchmaking space is full of sanitized, aspirational content. Masii goes the other way. We acknowledge that finding a partner is hard, that family dynamics are complicated, that being single in your 30s in an Indian family comes with pressure. We don't pretend it's all "exciting."

□ Emotionally Honest	□ Sanitized/Generic
"Looking for a partner when your parents have opinions? Yeah, we get it."	"Start your exciting journey to find love!"
"Some days you want to just handle it yourself. Other days you wish someone would help."	"Let us do the hard work for you!"
"Not everyone wants an arranged marriage. Not everyone wants to go solo. Masii works in between."	"The modern way to find your match!"

4. Community First, Product Second

Masii's content should feel like it belongs in a community, not on a product page. Share observations about diaspora life. Tell stories. Ask questions. The product will come up naturally, but it should never feel like the point.

- 80% of content should be cultural observation, stories, relatable moments
- 20% of content should be product-specific (features, how it works, CTAs)
- Every product post should still feel like it's about people, not technology

Language Style Guide

Element	Rule	Example
Sentence length	Short. Punchy. Conversational.	"You tell Masii everything. She tells no one."
Contractions	Always. Never formal.	"She's not a form. She's your masi."
Hindi/Gujarati	Use naturally. Don't italicize or	"Your masi doesn't need a rishta

words	translate every time.	resume."
Humor	Dry, observational. Never slapstick. Never at someone’s expense.	"Your mom’s friend’s son is not a dating strategy."
Questions	Use often. Rhetorical questions pull people in.	"When was the last time someone asked what YOU actually want?"
Em dashes	Use liberally—they create pause and emphasis.	"Not a carousel—a conviction."
Exclamation marks	Almost never. Conviction doesn’t shout.	"You deserve to meet." not "You deserve to meet!"
Emojis	Sparingly. □ is the brand emoji. Avoid 😊	□ for sign-offs, that’s it.

SECTION 2

Visual Identity Guidelines

Color Palette

Color	Hex	Usage
Saffron	#E8833A	Primary accent. CTAs, highlights, warmth.
Deep Plum	#4A1942	Headlines, authority, depth.
Warm Cream	#FFF8F0	Backgrounds. Never cold white.
Soft Gold	#D4A843	Secondary accent. Premium feel.
Charcoal	#2D2D2D	Body text. Never pure black.

- Never use bright red, pink, or stereotypical “romance” colors
- Never use neon or tech-startup blue/green palettes
- Backgrounds should always feel warm—cream, not white

Typography

Use Case	Font Recommendation	Why
Headlines & Titles	Playfair Display or Libre Baskerville	Elegant serif. Feels literary, not corporate.
Body Text	DM Sans or Inter	Clean, modern, excellent readability.
Accent / Quotes	Cormorant Garamond Italic	Beautiful for pull-quotes and testimonials.
Masii’s Voice (bot)	Space Grotesk or IBM Plex Sans	Slightly technical, approachable. Signals “AI but friendly.”

All these fonts are free on Google Fonts and available in Canva Pro.

Imagery Rules

▯ Use	▯ Avoid
Warm, natural-light photography	Stock photos with fake smiles
Solo portraits showing confidence	Couples in overly romantic poses
Cultural textures (textiles, food, architecture)	Henna hands, red bangles, Bollywood clichés
Abstract patterns inspired by rangoli/kolam	Literal religious iconography

Candid family moments	Staged “happy Indian family” photos
Illustrations with warm color palette	Clipart, cartoon characters, 3D renders

Pro tip for Canva: Search for “warm portrait Indian” or “diaspora lifestyle” rather than “Indian wedding” or “Indian couple.” The former gives you editorial quality. The latter gives you stereotypes.

SECTION 3

The 4-Phase Marketing Plan

This is your roadmap from zero to traction. Each phase builds on the last. Don't skip ahead—the early phases build the credibility that makes later phases work.

PHASE 1: SOUL | Weeks 1–4 | "Who are we?"

Goal: Establish Masii's voice and worldview before asking anyone to sign up. Build recognition, not conversions.

Tone: Observational, warm, slightly provocative. Like a smart friend sharing thoughts over chai.

Content Mix (3–4 posts/week):

- Cultural observations about diaspora dating life (60%)
- Behind-the-scenes: why you're building Masii, what's broken (25%)
- Soft product teases—the philosophy, not the features (15%)

Example Posts:

1. "Your mom wants you married. You want to choose. Masii thinks both can be true."
2. "Shaadi.com has 50 million profiles. How many of those are actually compatible with you? We'd guess: 7."
3. "We're building an AI matchmaker that doesn't show you 50 profiles. She finds you one person—and tells you why."
4. "There are 5 kinds of vegetarian in the Indian community. Your dating app knows about zero of them."

Channels: Instagram (carousels + reels), X (text posts + threads)

No WhatsApp yet. You haven't earned the right to be in someone's DMs. That comes later.

PHASE 2: STORIES | Weeks 5–10 | "Why does this matter?"

Goal: Build emotional investment through real stories. Make people feel seen. Start collecting emails/WhatsApp opt-ins.

Tone: Intimate, story-driven, empathetic. Less witty commentary, more depth.

Content Mix (4–5 posts/week):

- Real stories—anonymized user journeys, cultural tension points (40%)
- "What Masii would say" scenarios—relatable matchmaking dilemmas (25%)
- Product reveals—how Masii actually thinks about matching (20%)
- Community engagement—polls, questions, “tell me your story” (15%)

Example Posts:

5. "Aarti’s parents wanted a Gujarati boy from a good family. Aarti wanted someone who made her laugh. Masii found Jay—who happened to be both." [Carousel: the full story]
6. "What would Masii say if you told her you’re 34 and your parents check Shaadi.com more than you do?" [Reel: conversational, warm]
7. "Here’s something dating apps won’t tell you: the reason you’re not finding someone isn’t because there’s no one out there. It’s because the system is designed to keep you swiping, not to help you decide." [Thread on X]

New channel unlocked: YouTube Shorts. 60-second story snippets and “What would Masii say” scenarios work perfectly here.

Start building your WhatsApp list. "Want early access? Drop your number.” Use a simple Typeform or Google Form.

PHASE 3: SIGNAL | Weeks 11–18 | “This is real.”

Goal: Convert awareness into signups. Show proof. Create urgency through community unlock.

Tone: Confident, proof-driven, community-oriented. Less wondering, more showing.

Content Mix (5–6 posts/week):

- Social proof—match stories, user quotes, numbers (35%)
- Product deep-dives—how matching works, what Masii asks, why (25%)
- Community unlock campaigns—“50 more Gujaratis in Toronto and we launch there” (20%)
- Influencer collaborations—relatable voices sharing Masii’s story (20%)

Example Posts:

8. "89% average match score. That’s not because we’re lenient. It’s because we’d rather show you no one than the wrong one." [Static post with stat]
9. "23 matches this month. 23 introductions where both people said yes before seeing each other. That’s what conviction looks like." [Carousel with numbers]
10. "Houston Gujaratis: we’re 37 signups away from unlocking your city. You know what to do." [Story + WhatsApp forward]

WhatsApp goes live. Forward-optimized content: short, personal, with a clear CTA. This is your word-of-mouth engine.

Influencer outreach starts. See the Influencer Playbook in Section 4.

PHASE 4: SCALE | Weeks 19+ | "Join the movement."

Goal: Expand to new communities. Automate what works. Build referral loops.

Tone: Established, celebratory, inviting. Masii has proven herself—now she's growing.

Content Mix:

- Success stories at scale—real couples, real families happy (30%)
- Community spotlights—"Masii in Melbourne," "Masii in Mumbai" (25%)
- Referral campaigns—"Tell your cousin. Seriously." (20%)
- Cultural content that's become a brand signature (25%)

Automation kicks in: Scheduled posts, WhatsApp broadcast lists by city, automated onboarding flows, referral tracking.

SECTION 4

Channel Playbooks

Instagram

Role: Your visual home. Where people discover Masii and get a feel for the brand.

Format	What to Post	Frequency
Carousels (5–10 slides)	Stories, cultural explainers, "did you know" series, match philosophy	2–3/week
Reels (30–60 sec)	"What would Masii say" scenarios, cultural observations, relatable moments	2–3/week
Stories	Polls, Q&A, behind-the-scenes, signup links, community unlocks	Daily
Static posts	Key stats, powerful one-liners, user quotes	1/week

Instagram Tone:

- Visual warmth—saffron and cream palette, editorial photography
- Captions are conversational, 2–4 sentences max for feed posts
- Carousels tell a story—each slide should make you want the next
- Hashtags: #MasiiMatchmaker #YouDeserveToMeet #DiasporaDating #IndianMatchmaking #CultureNotCheckbox (use 8–12, mix branded and discovery)

X (Twitter)

Role: Your sharpest voice. Cultural commentary, hot takes, building in public.

Format	What to Post	Frequency
Single tweets	Observations, one-liners, questions	1–2/day
Threads (5–10 tweets)	Deep dives: why matching is broken, how Masii thinks, founder reflections	1–2/week
Quote tweets / replies	Engage with diaspora conversations, dating discourse, cultural moments	Opportunistic
Polls	"Would you let your parents help pick your partner?" style questions	1/week

X Tone:

- Sharper, wittier, more provocative than Instagram

- Think “smart friend at a dinner party” not “brand account”
- OK to be slightly edgy about the dating industry. Never mean about users.
- Build in public: share learnings, numbers, decisions openly

WhatsApp Forwards

Role: Your word-of-mouth engine. Where aunties and friends share Masii’s story.

Critical rule: WhatsApp content must be forward-worthy. If someone wouldn’t forward it to their cousin or mom, it doesn’t belong here.

Format	What to Send	When
Text message (< 200 words)	Match stories, community unlock updates, personal asks	1–2/week max
Image + caption	Key stats, powerful quotes, community milestones	1/week
Voice note style	Personal founder update (text formatted as if spoken)	Monthly
Simple link	"Know someone who’s looking? Share this." + signup link	With every message

WhatsApp Tone:

- Personal. Like you’re texting one person, not broadcasting.
- Shorter is better. Under 200 words, always.
- Include a reason to forward: “Know someone who’d relate?”
- NEVER feel like spam. If you wouldn’t send it to your own mom, don’t send it.

YouTube Shorts / Instagram Reels

Role: Discovery engine. Reach people who’ve never heard of Masii through relatable, shareable video.

Video Formats That Work:

11. **"What Would Masii Say"** (30–45 sec): Present a relatable dilemma, then Masii’s take. Text on screen + voiceover.
12. **"5 Types of..."** (45–60 sec): Cultural listicles. “5 types of vegetarian your dating app doesn’t know about.”
13. **"Story Time"** (45–60 sec): Anonymized match stories. “She wanted X. He wanted Y. Masii saw Z.”
14. **"The Problem With..."** (30–45 sec): Quick takes on what’s broken in dating/matchmaking.

Video Production (Zero Budget):

- Use Canva Pro for text-on-screen videos—no face needed
- Stock footage from Canva + warm color overlay = editorial feel
- Voiceover via AI (ElevenLabs free tier) or your own voice—authenticity wins
- Add subtitles always—80%+ of viewers watch on mute

Influencer & Community Outreach

Strategy: Masii doesn't need mega-influencers. You need community voices—people with 5K–50K followers who are trusted in specific diaspora communities.

Who to Target:

Persona	Why They Work	How to Approach
Diaspora lifestyle creators	Already talk about cultural identity, food, family	DM with genuine appreciation for their content + personal Masii story
Desi comedy accounts	Relatable content about family pressure, dating	Collab on a "What Would Masii Say" skit
Relationship / self-growth pages	Audience already thinking about finding a partner	Offer them early access to try Masii + share honest review
Community leaders (temple, cultural orgs)	Trusted voices in tight-knit communities	Personal outreach, offer to present Masii at community events
Parents who are active on social	Huge untapped audience. They want their kids to find someone too.	Content specifically for parents: "A masi for your son/daughter"

Outreach Template (DM/Email):

> Hey [Name], I've been following your content on [specific thing you liked]. It really resonated because [genuine reason]. I'm building something called Masii—an AI matchmaker for Indians everywhere. Not a dating app. More like having a really smart, tireless masi who actually listens. I'd love for you to try it and share your honest take with your community. No script, no obligation. Would you be open to a quick chat? — Nik

Key rule: Never offer payment you can't afford. Offer early access, a story to tell, and genuine relationship. Micro-influencers respond to authenticity, not money.

SECTION 5

Tone Files by Context

Masii's core voice stays consistent. But the dial turns depending on where you're speaking and who's listening.

Context	Tone Dial	Think Of It As...	Example
Instagram Feed	Warm + Visual + Inviting	A beautifully set table	"Culture isn't a checkbox. It's the air you breathe."
Instagram Stories	Casual + Interactive + Quick	Texting a friend	"Quick poll: arranged or love marriage? (trick question: both)"
Instagram Reels	Punchy + Relatable + Shareable	A friend's hot take at dinner	"POV: Your mom finds out you're on Bumble"
X / Twitter	Sharp + Provocative + Thoughtful	The smartest person in the room	"Shaadi.com is LinkedIn for marriage. Masii is your masi for marriage."
X Threads	Deep + Analytical + Story-driven	A long conversation over chai	"Here's why I left my job to build a matchmaker. A thread."
WhatsApp	Personal + Intimate + Respectful	A note from a trusted friend	"Priya, I know someone you should meet. Can I tell you more?"
YouTube Shorts	Visual + Story-first + Hook-driven	A mini-documentary trailer	"She wanted someone who understood garba. He grew up in Ohio."
Blog / Long-form	Reflective + Nuanced + Authoritative	An essay in a good magazine	"The case for fewer matches: why choice overload is killing modern dating"
Influencer Briefs	Collaborative + Authentic + Flexible	A respectful creative partner	"Make it yours. We'd love your honest take."
Parent-facing	Respectful + Reassuring + Familiar	A trusted family friend	"Masii is like having a connected masi working 24/7 for your child."

SECTION 6

Content Templates & Frameworks

These are plug-and-play structures. Fill in the blanks and you have a post. Use these until you develop your own rhythm.

Template 1: The Cultural Observation

> [Observation about something uniquely Indian/diaspora] [Why it matters for matchmaking/relationships] [What Masii does differently because of it] □ masii.com

Example: *"There are 5 kinds of vegetarian in the Indian community. Your dating app knows about zero of them. Masii asks because it matters. masii.com"*

Template 2: The Emotional Hook

> [Relatable feeling or situation] [Acknowledgment that it's hard/complicated] [What would be different if...] [Masii's role, understated] □

Example: *"Some days you want to just handle it yourself. Other days you wish someone would help. Masii's here for both those days."*

Template 3: The "What Masii Would Say"

> You: [Common thing someone tells a matchmaker] Masii: [Warm, direct, slightly funny response] You: [Follow-up or surprise] Masii: [The real insight]

Example: *"You: I want someone who's family-oriented but not TOO close to their mom. / Masii: Define 'too close.' / You: Like... they talk every day. / Masii: That's 73% of my users. Let's talk about what you actually mean."*

Template 4: The Builder's Note (X / Thread)

> Something happened this week building Masii that I want to share. [The insight / challenge / learning] [Why it matters] [What we decided to do] Building in public because you deserve to know how your matchmaker thinks.

Template 5: The Community Unlock (WhatsApp)

> Masii update for [City/Community]: We're [X] signups away from launching in [location]. [One line about why this community is special to us] Know someone who's looking? Forward this. □ masii.com

Template 6: The Match Story (Carousel/Reel)

Slide 1: [Her name] wanted [X]. [His name] wanted [Y]. Slide 2: What most apps would do: show them 50 profiles each. Slide 3: What Masii did: [The specific insight that connected them] Slide 4: The match score: [X]%. Here's what that means. Slide 5: They're talking. That's all we'll say. □

SECTION 7

The Do / Don’t Bible

Print this. Tape it to your wall. Check every piece of content against it.

Voice & Messaging

□ DO	□ DON’T
Speak with conviction, not hype	Use superlatives: “best,” “#1,” “amazing”
Acknowledge complexity—dating is hard, family is complicated	Oversimplify: “Finding love is easy with Masii!”
Be specific about culture: gotra, Jain vs Hindu vegetarian, language as identity	Be generic: “We celebrate diversity!”
Let the product speak through stories and philosophy	Lead with features and tech specs
Use humor that comes from observation	Use humor that punches down or stereotypes
Mix Hindi/Gujarati words naturally	Force desi slang or use it performatively
Say “you deserve to meet”	Say “find your soulmate” or “find the one”
Be transparent: “Masii is AI. She’s honest about it.”	Hide the AI or pretend Masii is human

Visual & Design

□ DO	□ DON’T
Use warm, editorial-quality imagery	Use stock photos of couples with fake smiles
Stick to the saffron/plum/cream palette	Use bright pinks, reds, or “romantic” colors
Use serif fonts for headlines (Playfair, Libre Baskerville)	Use generic sans-serif for everything
Show solo portraits that convey confidence	Show couples in Bollywood-style romance poses
Use □ as the brand emoji	Litter posts with 😍
Reference cultural textures (textiles, food, architecture)	Use henna hands, sindoor, mangalsutra as visuals
Let whitespace breathe in your designs	Cram text into every inch of a graphic

Strategy & Channels

□ DO	□ DON’T

Start with brand voice before asking for signups	Launch with “Sign up now!” as your first post
Build community trust before scaling	Run paid ads before you have organic credibility
Make WhatsApp content forward-worthy	Spam WhatsApp groups with signup links
Engage authentically in comments and DMs	Use generic auto-responses
Post consistently (3–5x/week) rather than in bursts	Post 10 times in one week then disappear for a month
Test different content types and double down on what works	Commit to one format and never experiment
Target micro-influencers (5K–50K) in diaspora niches	Chase mega-influencers who have no cultural connection
Track what’s working (saves, shares, DMs > likes)	Obsess over follower count

SECTION 8

Measurement & Iteration

You're bootstrapped. You can't afford to guess. Here's what to track and what to ignore.

Metrics That Matter

Metric	Why It Matters	Target (Phase 1–2)	Target (Phase 3–4)
Saves (Instagram)	People saving = content they'll return to. Strongest signal.	50+ per post	200+ per post
Shares / Forwards	Word-of-mouth is your growth engine	10+ per post	50+ per post
DMs received	People engaging privately = high intent	5+ per week	20+ per week
WhatsApp list size	Your owned audience	100	1,000+
Signup conversions	People who actually create a Masii profile	Track from Phase 2	5–10% of reach
Community unlock progress	Are specific cities/communities growing?	Track from Phase 3	1 city/month
X thread engagement	Replies and quote tweets (not likes)	10+ replies	50+ replies

Metrics That Don't Matter (Yet)

- **Follower count.** 500 engaged followers > 10,000 passive ones.
- **Likes.** The weakest form of engagement. Saves and shares move the needle.
- **Impressions/Reach.** Vanity metric at this stage. Focus on depth, not width.
- **Competitor follower counts.** You're not competing for the same audience.

Weekly Review Ritual (15 minutes)

Every Sunday evening, answer these five questions:

15. Which post got the most saves/shares this week? Why?
16. Did anyone DM me about Masii? What did they say?
17. What's my WhatsApp list size? Did it grow?
18. What content felt forced or got no engagement? Stop doing that.
19. What's one experiment I'll try next week?

When to Pivot

- If a content format gets no engagement for 3 weeks straight, drop it
- If a channel feels like a chore and produces no signups, pause it
- If a specific story/angle gets 3x normal engagement, build a series around it
- If influencer outreach gets ignored 10+ times, change the pitch—not the strategy

---

You deserve to meet.

Now go help others do the same.

masii.com